



Chalkboard or laptop?

This chalkboard skin for laptop lids is probably the coolest ever!

<http://dgit.in/chalkboardltp>

Sony launches SmartBand 2

Sony's SmartBand 2 informs you about your fitness, moods and stress levels.

<http://dgit.in/sonysmrtd2>

Industry connect

powered end-to-end. Currently, ARM has over 1 lakh mbed developers, more than 12,000 published programs and libraries, and 45+ platform implementations. With all these aggressive plans, ARM's surely looking forward to making greater inroads into the IoT space in collaboration with partners designing innovative digital solutions for customer needs very soon. And to think that ARM's RISC chips are poised to be one of the biggest enablers of IoT, in all its various complexities, isn't without its sense of irony.

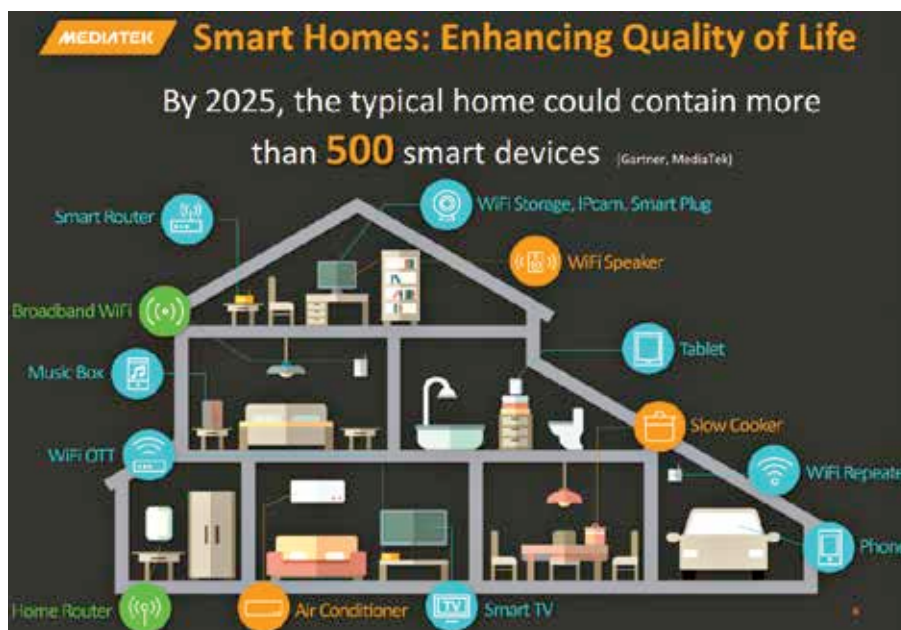
Another company betting big on IoT is MediaTek – we all love it in India primarily for launching a wave of high-performance yet inexpensive handsets in the market. Here's what it's doing to further the IoT industry as a whole.

MediaTek offers complete hardware and software to provide an integrated application platform for developers to build next-generation IoT solutions. Its advanced SoCs are high on performance without compromising on battery life and are geared for multimedia, and its chipsets support a number of communication and connectivity protocols. MediaTek firmly believes that by 2017, 50 percent of IoT solutions will be developed by startups

According to IDC estimates, the current IoT market is worth \$656 billion. And by 2020, the total market size of IoT could reach up to a whopping \$1.7 trillion.

that are less than three years old. To power these startups and solutions and to widen their appeal to potential customers, MediaTek is carrying out many activities through its 'Labs' initiative.

MediaTek Labs supports developers through device creation, app development, and services rollout – all for free. The online website of MediaTek Labs also helps out developers in terms of SDKs, HDKs, access to technical documents, solutions catalogue and a service called 'Labs Partner Connect' – and through this, MediaTek targets DIYers and makers as well as professional developers trying to create constantly connected smart home or office solutions.



MediaTek's vision of all the connected devices in our homes by 2025

At its office in Taiwan, MediaTek demonstrated a range of IoT applications and services developed through its Labs initiative. A smart wine brewer, 'Skuromoto' (freely accessible scooters for campus students), smart light, fan and intrusion detection system for homes, wearable devices in the form of smartwatches, shoes and more, non-invasive heart rate monitor, etc.

Well, so far we've learned what a great opportunity IoT presents in the scheme of all things digital. But no one has spoken about its challenges. At MediaTek, we received an answer to this question as well. According to MediaTek, the IoT space faces three critical challenges – interoperability, security and business model. Devices capable of multiple standards are few and far in between, and frankly there are too many independent, proprietary ecosystems, which need to come together and talk to each other to exchange data at a very basic level. Software and hardware companies need to tackle the problem of security together and not in isolation, according to MediaTek, if IoT as an ecosystem needs to grow stronger in the coming future. And one of the most basic challenges for IoT is business models not fine-tuned to capitalise on the opportunity it presents.

For evolving business models, there's a need for cross-industry cooperation for common learning and revenue sharing.

More smart solutions: Holux, Taiwan Sakura & Mobiletron

Last but not least, we also visited the factories of a few Taiwanese companies – Holux, Taiwan Sakura and Mobiletron. Let's look at them one by one.

With just 150 employees, including factory workers on the assembly line, Holux is a small yet innovative company doing great things on IoT. It's focusing on two verticals – smart homes and wearables. It claims to have made the world's first smartwatch with driving fatigue detection algorithm (recently patented in the US), and has a whole host of temperature, humidity and air quality sensors meant for use in home and industrial applications. Taiwan Sakura is making smart home devices such as smart stove, smart water heater, smart kitchen and more. Mobiletron has been a leader in automotive electronics for over 30 years, and it has made great advancements in fully robotic, remote-controlled factory floors, hardware fabrication and fleet control services. It recently got an Indian transport giant to collaborate with it for Internet-controlled and monitored transport fleet. **[4]**